

PPC Guru

# How PPC Guru Scaled Its Own Meta Ads Lead Engine to 80 Leads a Month at ~\$19 Each

Digital Marketing Agency · Canada · Managed since Jun 2024

**80**

FORM LEADS / MONTH

July 2026

**~\$19**

COST PER LEAD

▼ from ~\$79 in 2024 pilot

**▼ 76%**

COST PER LEAD

vs the 2024 pilot

PPC Guru applied its own methodology to its own Meta Ads account — turning a small 2024 pilot that produced about 8 instant-form leads a month at roughly \$79 each into a scaled 2026 engine delivering 80 genuine form leads in July 2026 at about \$19 each, a cost per lead roughly 76% lower even as monthly budget more than doubled.

## About the Client

PPC Guru is a Canadian digital marketing agency that runs paid search and paid social for clients across a range of local-service industries. This case study covers the agency's own Meta Ads account — the lead engine it uses to generate new-client enquiries. Because it is PPC Guru's own account, it doubles as a live test bed for the instant-form lead-generation approach the agency deploys for clients, which makes the cost and volume of genuine form leads the metric that matters.

## How the Account Came to PPC Guru

The account began as a small pilot in mid-2024 to validate a Meta instant-form approach for agency lead generation. After the pilot proved the concept, the account was paused while attention went to client work, then relaunched and scaled in 2026 with a refined campaign structure and a clear instant-form lead objective. This case study compares the original pilot with the scaled 2026 engine.

## The Challenge

As with many agencies, PPC Guru's own marketing competes for attention with client work, and the early 2024 pilot — while it proved the concept — carried a high cost per lead of around \$79 and only a handful of leads a month. The challenge on relaunch was to rebuild the account into a dependable, low-cost lead engine that could scale without the cost per lead climbing.

## What We Analyzed & Planned

PPC Guru treated its own account the way it treats a client's: prove the lead mechanism at small budget, then scale only once the cost per genuine lead is low and stable. The 2026 relaunch concentrated on instant-form campaigns so every dollar could be measured against a real, countable lead rather than a surface engagement.

- Use Meta instant forms so leads are genuine, countable submissions rather than clicks or reach.
- Prove the mechanism at pilot budget before committing to scale.
- Concentrate the 2026 relaunch on lead-objective campaigns and manage to cost per lead.
- Scale monthly budget only after cost per lead proved low and repeatable.

## What PPC Guru Did & Why

|                                        |                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Instant-form lead campaigns            | Captured genuine, countable enquiries directly inside Meta so every dollar maps to a real lead, not a click.               |
| Pilot-then-scale discipline            | Validated the mechanism at small budget in 2024, then scaled spend in 2026 only after cost per lead proved low and stable. |
| Rebuilt campaign structure on relaunch | Re-established audiences and creative in early 2026 at low CPCs before pushing volume.                                     |
| Managed to cost per lead               | Kept efficiency the target as budget scaled, so more spend bought proportionally more leads.                               |

### UNDER THE HOOD

|                       |                                             |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Platform              | Meta (Facebook & Instagram)                 |
| Objective             | Lead generation (instant forms) + messaging |
| Lead signal           | Instant-form submissions                    |
| Monthly budget (2026) | ≈ \$1,300–1,500 CAD                         |
| Markets               | Canada (+ some USA tests)                   |
| Currency              | CAD                                         |

## The Account Timeline

- 2024 pilot (Jun–Sep) A small validation run averaged a handful of instant-form leads a month; July 2024 delivered 8 leads at about \$79 each.
- Late 2024 – early 2026 Account paused while focus shifted to client work — no delivery for about 16 months.
- Mar–Apr 2026 Relaunch — messaging and lead campaigns rebuilt and audiences re-established at low CPCs.
- May–Jul 2026 Instant-form volume scaled to 54, 54 and 80 leads a month at roughly \$19–24 each.

## Pilot vs Scale-Up

The 2024 pilot proved the instant-form mechanism at a modest budget, delivering 8 leads in July 2024 at about \$79 each. After the 2026 relaunch, instant-form volume scaled sharply while cost per lead fell to roughly a quarter of the pilot level.

| Period              | Spend   | Form Leads | Cost / Lead |
|---------------------|---------|------------|-------------|
| Pilot (Jul 2024)    | \$633   | 8          | \$79.09     |
| Scale-up (May 2026) | \$1,083 | 54         | \$20.06     |
| Scale-up (Jun 2026) | \$1,283 | 54         | \$23.75     |
| Now (Jul 2026)      | \$1,487 | 80         | \$18.59     |

## Gradual Improvement, Month by Month

The two eras tell a clear pilot-to-scale story. In 2024 the account produced a handful of instant-form leads a month at a high cost per lead, enough to prove the approach worked. After a pause and a 2026 relaunch — which re-established audiences through lower-cost messaging and lead campaigns in March and April — instant-form volume

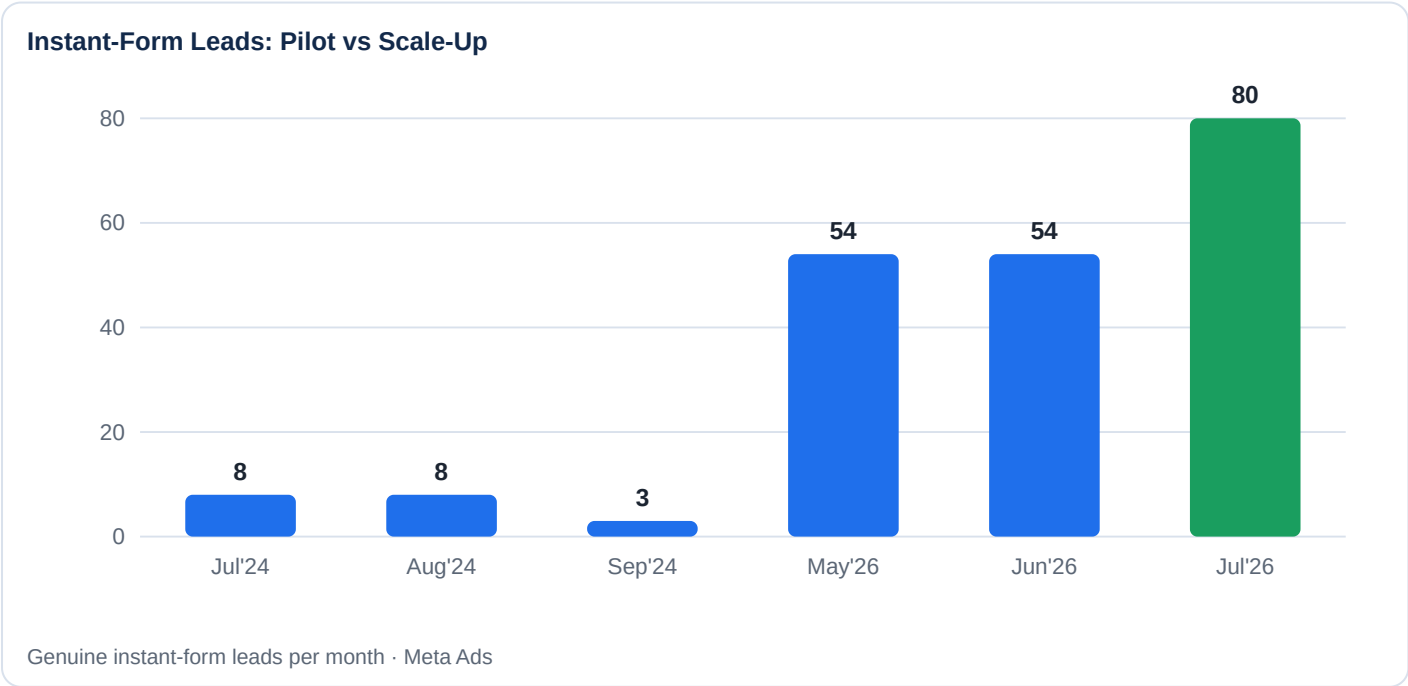
scaled to 54 leads in May, held at 54 in June, and reached 80 in July at about \$19 each. The chart below shows the leap from the pilot to the scaled engine; the gap between the eras reflects the paused period and is shown honestly.



## Results

| Metric                     | 2024 pilot (Jul, /mo) | Now (Jul 2026) | Change              |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| Instant-form leads / month | 8                     | 80             | ▲ Strong growth     |
| Cost per lead              | ≈ \$79                | ≈ \$19         | ▼ Much lower        |
| Click-through rate         | ≈ 1.1%                | ≈ 1.9%         | ▲ Higher            |
| Monthly ad spend           | ≈ \$633               | ≈ \$1,487      | Scaled with results |

Leads are Meta instant-form submissions reported directly by the account. The 2024 pilot and the 2026 scale-up are separated by a roughly 16-month pause, so this is a pilot-to-scale relaunch rather than a continuous run. Cost per lead fell from about \$79 in the pilot to about \$19 in the most recent month while monthly budget more than doubled.



## Why It Worked

- ✓ Instant forms produced genuine, countable leads that spend could be measured against.
- ✓ A pilot-first approach de-risked the scale-up and kept cost per lead in check.
- ✓ The 2026 rebuild re-established audiences at low CPCs before pushing volume.
- ✓ Managing to cost per lead meant more than double the budget delivered ten times the leads.

## Lessons for Agencies & Service Businesses

- 1 Use instant forms so you count genuine leads, not clicks or reach.
- 2 Prove the lead mechanism at a small budget before you scale spend.
- 3 Judge the account on cost per genuine lead, not on impressions or engagement.
- 4 Scale budget only after cost per lead is low and repeatable across months.
- 5 Practise on your own account what you deploy for clients — it keeps the method honest.

## Where They Stand Today

PPC Guru's own Meta Ads account now runs as a dependable, low-cost lead engine. In the most recent complete month (July 2026) it delivered 80 genuine instant-form leads at about \$19 each — up from roughly 8 leads a month at about \$79 each in the 2024 pilot, a cost per lead roughly 76% lower even as monthly budget more than doubled. Just as importantly, the account proves in practice the instant-form lead approach the agency deploys for its clients.

### Want results like these?

PPC Guru helps Canadian businesses turn Facebook and Instagram into a predictable, low-cost lead engine with conversion-focused Meta Ads and transparent reporting.



*All figures are pulled directly from PPC Guru's own Meta Ads account and shown on a monthly basis. 'Leads' are Meta instant-form submissions — genuine, countable enquiries. Account-level 'results' are reported by Meta as unavailable because they were aggregated across different attribution settings, so instant-form submissions are used as the clean lead metric. 'Now' is the most recent complete month (July 2026); the 2024 pilot is the earlier baseline. A pause between the two eras is disclosed.*

Advertising results vary based on industry, market conditions, competition, budget, campaign history, offer, website experience, conversion tracking, and other factors. The results reflect the specific account and reporting periods shown and do not guarantee future performance.